

mid-\$60,000 range. Several were advised not to work while in school so they could focus on their studies. This is great advice for universities that lose income if underperforming students have to drop out. But it's horrible, and sadly common, advice for the students who will be trapped with massive debt and facing decades of work to pay it off.

Farrington said he hired over one thousand people while working as a Target store manager. He said, "The best hires were people that worked in high school and college and had that experience. Because college can give you some skills, but it doesn't teach you communication skills. It doesn't teach you on the job problem-solving skills. And in pretty much every single career, those are the two things that separate the successful from the not successful."

This statement resonated with me deeply. I worked throughout college in a variety of paid internships and jobs related to my field. This helped me to graduate college with no debt and two job offers. In contrast, many people I went to school with and students who I've mentored during my career routinely graduate with six-figure debt and no job prospects. They don't have a network and they lack experience, meaning they'll require extensive on-the-job training